

# OCGS Curriculum Vitae — Michael F Bergmann

Associate Professor, Performance, The Creative School, Toronto Metropolitan University

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## a) Name

Bergmann, Michael F. — Associate Professor, Performance, The Creative School, Toronto Metropolitan University

## b) Degrees

|                          |                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2022-09 – present</b> | PhD (in progress), Critical Studies in Improvisation, University of Guelph. Expected 2027.                                                            |
| <b>2011 – 2014</b>       | MFA, Design (Projection Design Specialization), Yale School of Drama, Yale University                                                                 |
| <b>2006 – 2011</b>       | BFA, Theatre Performance Production, Ryerson Theatre School, Toronto Metropolitan University (coursework completed December 2010; graduated May 2011) |

## c) Employment History

|                          |                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2024-01 – present</b> | Associate Professor (Tenured), Performance, The Creative School, Toronto Metropolitan University |
| <b>2022-07 – 2023-07</b> | Co-Undergraduate Program Director (Production), Performance, The Creative School, TMU            |
| <b>2019-08 – 2024-01</b> | Assistant Professor, Performance, The Creative School, Toronto Metropolitan University           |
| <b>2017 – present</b>    | Full Member, Yeates School of Graduate Studies, TMU                                              |
| <b>2016-08 – 2019-08</b> | Assistant Professor (Limited Term Faculty), Performance, The Creative School, TMU                |
| <b>2014 – 2016</b>       | Technology Specialist / Media Server Programmer, WorldStage LAB, San Francisco / New York        |
| <b>2007 – 2010</b>       | Projection Specialist, Meet The Dude Productions, Toronto                                        |

## d) Honours

|                    |                                                                                  |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2022</b>        | Best World Feature Film: Nuptials, Austin Revolution Film Festival (as producer) |
| <b>2014</b>        | Best Production: He Left Quietly, SummerWorks Performance Festival (as designer) |
| <b>2012 – 2014</b> | Eldon Elder Fellowship, Yale University (\$40,000 USD; held throughout the MFA)  |
| <b>2009</b>        | Spirit of the Fringe, Prague Fringe Festival                                     |

**2006**

Short-listed, Prix Molière, Theatre Glendon

## **e) Scholarly and Professional Academic Activities**

|                          |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2026-06 – present</b> | Judge, Music, Film & Theatre panel, The Global Undergraduate Awards, Dublin                                                |
| <b>2026-04</b>           | Co-chair (with Dr. Afsoon Soudi), 3rd Annual Creative AI Symposium, Creative AI Hub, TMU                                   |
| <b>2025-07 – present</b> | Member, Creative AI Hub Steering Committee, The Creative School, TMU                                                       |
| <b>2025-02 – present</b> | Member, USITT Research and Creative Endeavours Committee                                                                   |
| <b>2024-12 – present</b> | Member, Faculty Tenure Committee, The Creative School, TMU                                                                 |
| <b>2025-04 – present</b> | Board Member, UKAI Projects                                                                                                |
| <b>2024-06 – present</b> | Reviewer, International Journal of Performance Arts and Digital Media                                                      |
| <b>2023-10 – present</b> | Jury Member, CATR Scholarship and Grant Committee (Heather McCallum Scholarship, Robert Lawrence Scholarship, CATR Grants) |
| <b>2023 – present</b>    | Reviewer, EVA London Conference on Electronic Visualisation and the Arts                                                   |
| <b>2023 – 2024</b>       | Technical Advisory Board Member, UKAI Projects                                                                             |
| <b>2023 – 2024</b>       | Member, 360 Working Group, School of Performance, TMU                                                                      |
| <b>2023</b>              | Reviewer, Canada Foundation for Innovation                                                                                 |
| <b>2022 – 2024</b>       | Senator (The Creative School faculty representative), TMU Senate                                                           |
| <b>2022-03 – 2023</b>    | Secretary of the Board, Guild Festival Theatre                                                                             |
| <b>2021 – 2022</b>       | Member, Immersive Production Steering Committee, The Creative School, TMU                                                  |
| <b>2021</b>              | Member, Name Implementation Advisory Group (FCAD renaming to The Creative School), TMU                                     |
| <b>2020 – 2023</b>       | Member, Gold Medal selection committee (FCAD/Creative School section), TMU                                                 |
| <b>2020 – 2021</b>       | Member, Departmental Hiring Committee, Performance, TMU                                                                    |
| <b>2020 – present</b>    | Coordinator, Global Campus Studio course, TMU                                                                              |
| <b>2020</b>              | Member, FCAD Virtual Task Force, TMU                                                                                       |
| <b>2020-09 – 2021-09</b> | Member, Limited Return of Human Participant & Field SRC Activity Advisory Group, TMU                                       |
| <b>2019 – 2022</b>       | Member, Academic Integrity Committee, TMU                                                                                  |
| <b>2018 – 2022</b>       | School of Performance representative, RFA (now TFA) Representative's Council, TMU                                          |
| <b>2018 – 2023</b>       | Member, Creative Innovation Studio Curatorial Committee, The Creative School, TMU                                          |
| <b>2018 – 2020</b>       | FCAD Teaching Committee; FCAD Interdisciplinary Advisory Committee                                                         |
| <b>2017 – present</b>    | Member, Curriculum Committee, School of Performance, TMU                                                                   |

|                       |                                                                     |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2017 – present</b> | Member, Production Department Committee, School of Performance, TMU |
| <b>2016 – 2021</b>    | Member, Stage Committee, Arts & Letters Club of Toronto             |

## f) Graduate Supervisions

Completed: 9 Master's, 0 Doctoral, 0 Postdoctoral. In progress: 0.

|             |                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2022</b> | Aya Elmeligy, MDM (Second Reader), "Bridging Chasms: An Interactive Projection Mapping Installation for Cross-Cultural Exchange of Information." 2022.                            |
| <b>2021</b> | Emilie Trimbee, MDM (Supervisor), "AR-based Theatrical Design Pre-Visualization using Unreal." 2021.                                                                              |
| <b>2021</b> | Lindsay Christopher, MDM (Supervisor), "Casting and Technology: Revamping the Audition Process." 2021.                                                                            |
| <b>2021</b> | Shelby Bushell, MDM (Supervisor), "Collider: Using Virtual Reality for Immersive Theatre and the Performing Arts." 2021.                                                          |
| <b>2020</b> | Riley Erin Cooper, MDM (Supervisor), "Happiness In Your Hand: The power of compact Bright Light Therapy." 2020.                                                                   |
| <b>2020</b> | Yerachmiel Paquette, MDM (Supervisor), "The Scoop: How to Protect Your Digital Privacy in the Age of Surveillance Capitalism." 2020.                                              |
| <b>2020</b> | Kenyth Thomason, MFA in Technical Direction and Production, Yale University (Reader), "Live Video in Theatrical Productions." 2020.                                               |
| <b>2018</b> | Michael Castledine, MDM (Supervisor), "Extending the human umwelt: Reframing our understanding of an environment via mixed reality and digital soundscapes/visualizations." 2018. |
| <b>2017</b> | Soo Mahabir, MDM (Supervisor), "The A.I. Storyteller: Perpetuating Orality Using Developments in Machine Learning." 2017.                                                         |

## g) Graduate Courses

None — the School of Performance offers no graduate program; graduate work is supervised through the Master of Digital Media program (see f).

## h) Research Funding

### 1. External Research Funding

| Year | Source                | Program                                               | Type* | Amount   | PI               | Purpose** |
|------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------|------------------|-----------|
| 2024 | European Union / OAMK | Erasmus+ staff mobility                               | G     | —        | Michael Bergmann | Travel    |
| 2021 | SSHRC                 | Partnership Engage Grant, COVID-19 Special Initiative | C     | \$24,620 | Cintia Cristiá   | Research  |

| Year | Source          | Program                | Type* | Amount       | PI               | Purpose**  |
|------|-----------------|------------------------|-------|--------------|------------------|------------|
| 2012 | Yale University | Eldon Elder Fellowship | O     | \$40,000 USD | Michael Bergmann | Fellowship |

\*Type: C – Granting Councils; G – Government; F – Foundations; O – Other

\*\*Purpose: research, travel, publication, etc.

## 2. Internal Research Funding

| Year | Source                                         | Program                                   | Type* | Amount   | PI                          | Purpose** |
|------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------|----------|-----------------------------|-----------|
| 2024 | TMU                                            | The Creative School Travel Grant          | O     | \$1,000  | Michael Bergmann            | Travel    |
| 2022 | TMU                                            | Work Study RA Program                     | O     | \$3,800  | Michael Bergmann            | Research  |
| 2022 | TMU                                            | The Creative School Travel Grant          | O     | \$2,000  | Michael Bergmann            | Travel    |
| 2019 | Cirque du Soleil Entertainment Group / Ryerson | Future of Live Entertainment Lab          | O     | \$7,500  | Co-I with Jonathon Anderson | Research  |
| 2019 | Ryerson                                        | FCAD Special Seed Grant                   | O     | \$4,000  | Michael Bergmann            | Research  |
| 2019 | Ryerson                                        | The Creative School Travel Grant          | O     | \$2,000  | Michael Bergmann            | Travel    |
| 2018 | Ryerson                                        | Undergraduate Research Opportunity, OVPRI | O     | \$9,888  | Michael Bergmann            | Research  |
| 2018 | Ryerson                                        | Learning and Teaching Enhancement Fund    | O     | \$13,000 | Pavlo Bosyy                 | Research  |

\*Type: C – Granting Councils; G – Government; F – Foundations; O – Other

\*\*Purpose: research, travel, publication, etc.

## i) Publications

### Life-time summary

- Books authored: 0
- Books edited: 0
- Chapters in books: 0
- Papers in refereed journals: 0
- Papers in refereed conference proceedings: 1
- Major invited contributions and/or technical reports: 0
- Abstracts and/or papers read: 21

- Other (data sets, magazine and literary publications): 3

## **Papers in refereed conference proceedings**

**2022-07** Bouchard, D., Cristiá, C., Robert, D., and Bergmann, M. (2022). "Augmented Symphony: An augmented reality application for immersive music listening." Proceedings of EVA London 2022, Electronic Workshops in Computing, BCS Learning & Development, London, UK, July 4-8, 2022, pp. 208-209. DOI: 10.14236/ewic/EVA2022.39.

## **Abstracts and/or papers read**

**2025-09** Bergmann, M. "Hallucinating Children: Improvisation After the Algorithmic Shipwreck." Hugarflug: Unstable Systems, annual conference on artistic research, Iceland University of the Arts, Reykjavík, Iceland, September 12, 2025.

**2024-10** Bergmann, M. "Beyond Tools: Reimagining Technology as Co-Participants in Performance Design." PQ Symposium: Technologies in Theatre, Performance and Exhibition Design, Prague, Czech Republic, October 16-18, 2024.

**2024-03** Bergmann, M., Nathan, H., and Vercosa, J. "Robotics, AI, and the Future of Theatre." USITT Conference & Stage Expo, Seattle, WA, March 20, 2024.

**2024-01** Bergmann, M., Carravetta, L., Endahl, M., Robinson, A. D., and ARIA (AI). "Almost Alchemy." Poster, RUBIX, TMU, January 25, 2024.

**2023-06** Bergmann, M., with ChatGPT. "Envisioning theatre with non-human collaborators: A Paramanifesto." CATR Conference, Dalhousie University, Halifax, NS, June 2023.

**2023-06** Bergmann, M. "AI Sentience." Panel on the Implications of AI for Performance Theorists, CATR Conference (online), June 2023.

**2022-07** Bergmann, M. "Augmented Symphony: An augmented reality application for immersive music listening." Paper presented at EVA London 2022, London, UK, July 2022.

**2022-05** Bergmann, M., and Thomson, B. "Stepping Back In: Taking the best of virtual delivery to a new in-person experience." Learning & Teaching Conference, TMU, May 2022.

**2022-05** Bergmann, M. "Student-driven curriculum development for creative practice." Learning & Teaching Conference, TMU, May 2022.

**2021-10** Bergmann, M. "Cultivating Empathy through Robotic Performance." Limits of the Human, Machines Without Limits? Contemporary stage and robotics, University of Lausanne (online), October 2021.

**2021-06** Bergmann, M., O'Brien, C., and Thomson, B. "Unapologetically learning together: Adapting Production and Design curriculum to a virtual stage." University of the Arts London (online), June 2021.

- 2021-05** Bergmann, M., O'Brien, C., and Thomson, B. "Pandemic Performance: Adapting Production and Design curriculum to a virtual stage." Learning & Teaching Conference, Ryerson University, May 2021.
- 2020-11** Bergmann, M., and Anderson, J. "l'automate: Robotic Controlled Apparatuses for Circus Performance." Poster, RUBIX, TMU (online), November 2020.
- 2019-11** Bergmann, M., Zhang, L., Laberge-Côté, L., and McGuire, B. "Human-robot Interactions in Dance." Poster, RUBIX, TMU, November 2019.
- 2019-05** Bergmann, M., and Thomson, B. "Putting Up the Show: The very large group project." Ryerson Learning & Teaching Conference, May 2019.
- 2019-04** Bergmann, M. "Theatre in TheatAR: Explorations of augmented reality in theatrical performance." TEXT/SOUND/PERFORMANCE: Making in Canadian Space, University College Dublin, April 2019.
- 2018-11** Bergmann, M. "TheatAR: A previzualization system for theatrical design." Poster, RUBIX, TMU, November 2018.
- 2018-05** Bosy, P., and Bergmann, M. "The Creative Laboratory Project." Poster, Ryerson Learning & Teaching Conference, May 2018.
- 2018-03** Bergmann, M. "Technology as a tool: Creating a mindset of embracing technology within a theatrical framework." Theatre and Performance Design Pedagogy, University of the Arts London, March 2018.
- 2017-10** Bergmann, M. "Shadow-selves: Projection as a medium of exploring reflections of self in Belinda McGuire's Slaughterhouse/Requiem." Poster, RUBIX, TMU, October 2017.
- 2017-10** Bergmann, M. "Projecting on film: the surreal effect of rear projected backgrounds in the film Nuptials." Poster, RUBIX, TMU, October 2017.

### **Other (data sets, magazine and literary publications)**

- 2022-05** Cristiá, C., Bouchard, D., Bergmann, M., et al. (2022). Orchestra Remote Delivery during COVID-19 Database. Open data set, Open Science Framework, May 5, 2022. DOI: 10.17605/OSF.IO/WCDU2.
- 2021** Bergmann, M. F., and McGuire, B. (2021). "Uncanny Text." Belfield Literary Review: New TransAtlantic Dialogues, ed. Gregory Betts and Lucy Collins, Spring 2021, pp. 96-99.
- 2017-11** Bergmann, M. F. (2017). "Performance Art: New Magic." Rough Draft, Vol. 2, No. 1, ed. Laurence Butet-Roch, November 7, 2017.

### **Submitted and in-press (listed separately per OCGS instructions)**

- 2026** Bergmann, M. "Cultivating Empathy through Robotic Performance." Chapter in Robots and Other Artificial Agents on Stage: Theoretical Concepts and Artistic Practices, edited by Erica Magris and Izabella Pluta, transcript Verlag (Theatre Studies series). [in press]

**2026** Bergmann, M., and McLeod, K. "Improvising with Commercial AI: Questions of Care and Ethics." [in draft]

## **Creative and Professional Work**

**2026-04 – 2026-05** "Before I Was This." Generative text work. flashDRIVE: Digital Arts Fundraiser Exhibition, InterAccess, Toronto, April 22 – May 9, 2026. Curated by Miriam Arbus.

**2026-02** Nuptials (feature film). Producer, projection design, and live in-camera VFX. Directed by Sean Braune, Para-sight Productions. Official release February 13, 2026 (Freestyle Digital Media). Best World Feature Film, Austin Revolution Film Festival, 2022.

**2025-11** The Frankenstein Project. Producer, with Debashis Sinha. Performance Studio Theatre, TMU, November 18–22, 2025.

**2025-11** 291 by Jade O’Keeffe. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Lisa Dixon. Peterborough Theatre Guild, November 1–15, 2025.

**2025-04** "To my creators..." Solo work exhibited at the Creative AI Symposium, TMU, April 2, 2025; created during the SÍM residency, Reykjavík.

**2024-11** AVARA 2024 installation. Led eight students in a semester-long research-creation installation presented at AVARA 2024, OAMK, Oulu, Finland.

**2024-06** Shipwreck. Group exhibition with UKAI Projects and five Canadian artists, SÍM Gallery, Reykjavík, Iceland, following a month-long residency; includes solo work "To my creators..."

**2024-04** Labour and Us. Workshop series (March 14 – April 17, 2024) and performance, co-created and performed with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson; roundtable with Alan Filewod, Tom Scholte, Cynthia Ashperger, and Judith Thompson. ImprovLab, University of Guelph, April 19, 2024.

**2024-01** Almost Alchemy. Two 360° video experiences of improvised research-creation performance. RUBIX, TMU, January 25, 2024.

**2023-10** "rocketmanperson." Improvised performance with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson. Silence, Guelph, October 1, 2023.

**2023-04** "Who’s There?" Improvised performance with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson. Silence, Guelph, April 1, 2023.

**2023** Living Newspaper 2.0. Projection design; directed by Julie Labagnara. George Luscombe Theatre, Toronto.

**2019-10** "The Uncanny Robots Project: Phase 1." Research-creation premiere examining human-robot interaction through dance, commissioned for the opening of the Creative Technology Lab @ FCAD, TMU, October 2019.